Emlyn Atochon — Life and Professional Profile

Oct 29, 2026 · @emlyn

Snapshot

Emlyn Atochon, 24 (25 on 20 April 2027), is co-founder and Lead Designer of Formcraft Design and Construction in Kampala. He is a BIM manager and BIM automation developer with an interior architect's training and a workshop maker's knowledge of how things are built. Everything in Formcraft's system so far is his own work: the BIM standard, the Revit add-in with Claude working inside Revit, the family engine, the website design and the Studio and workshop output. The other founders currently review and test.

Experience. About 2–4 years of real project work, including employment at another firm and freelance design or drafting before Formcraft; under 2 years since graduating.

Scope. Five ventures (Formcraft, Soko Foods, Logistics, Nyumba and the Trade Assistant), each built and run with AI the way Formcraft's tools were, each with its own YouTube channel feeding an AI-automated website, and each aimed in stages at Kampala, Uganda, East Africa, Africa and the world, competing at every stage.

Background

Emlyn lost his last parent while in Senior Two and has made his own way since. He completed O-level at London College of St. Lawrence and at Sir Apollo Kaggwa's school (name to confirm), A-level at Makerere College School, and a bachelor's in interior architecture at Limkokwing University's Uganda campus. Everything since, from the first chair in 2023 to a registered company with its own software, he built without family backing.

That history explains two things in this profile: an unusual drive and self-reliance, and the habit of doing everything himself. The first is his biggest asset. The second is the source of the key-person risk the plans keep returning to.

Other skills

- **MQL5 programming (MetaTrader expert advisors): builds working trading bots.** Another sellable coding skill: expert advisors and indicators are sold and commissioned on the MQL5 marketplace and freelance boards.

- **Forex trading: learning, not yet profitable.** Teaches risk, probability and discipline; keep it strictly separate from company money.
- **JavaScript and web: built the Formcraft website alone with AI.** Same stack as the planned client dashboard and stores.
- **Furniture finishing (painting, staining, lacquer): practised.** The finish clients see first; can be taught in Academy workshop sessions.

A note on trading. Regulated brokers must warn that most retail accounts trading leveraged products lose money. Until a strategy has a long, recorded, profitable track record, trade only money you can afford to lose, never Formcraft's cash or reserve. Your MQL5 coding skill is worth more today as paid development work than as a trading strategy.

Chosen roles: paid MQL5 work for clients as extra dollar income; personal trading with small, separate capital; and trading or fintech software as a possible later business. Rules: no more than 10% of personal savings in trading, and no trading during Formcraft working hours.

Goals by age 30 (2032)

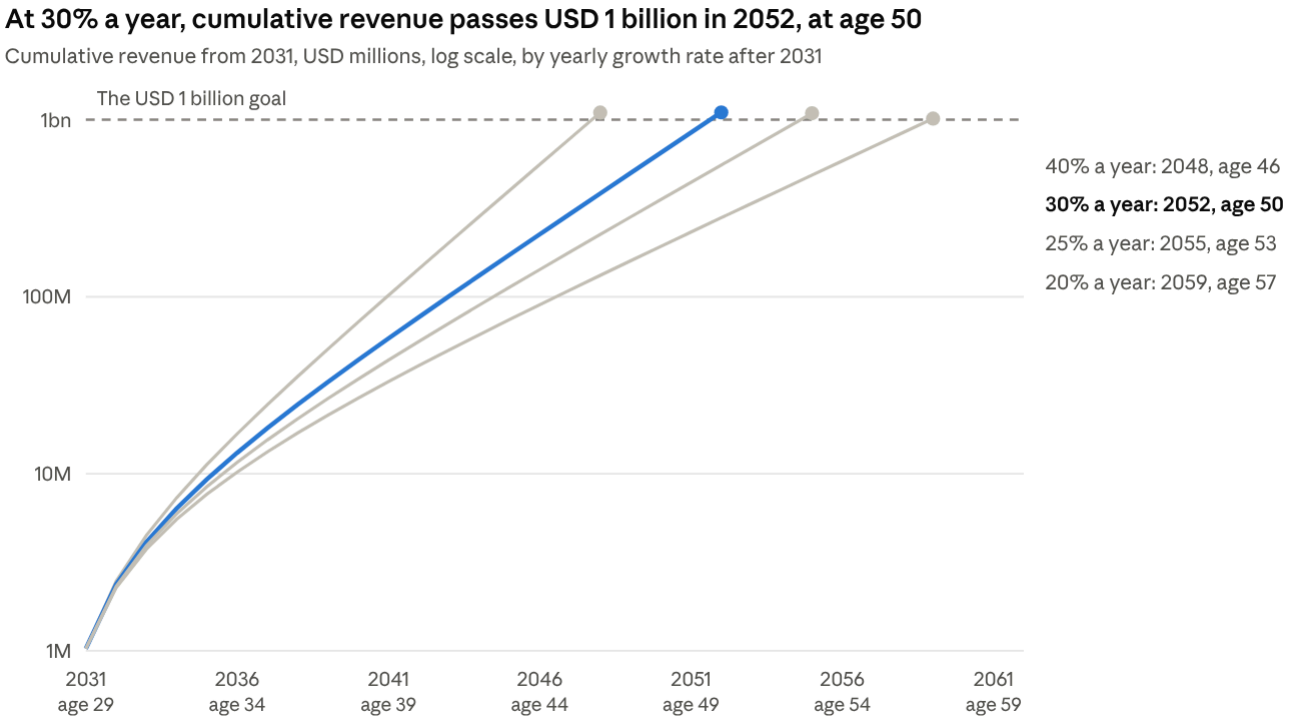
Emlyn wants all four, which is ambitious and possible only if they are sequenced:

1. **Lead Formcraft as a regional firm.** Takes the five-year plan and a team that runs without him. Obstacle: delegation, which is not yet a focus area.
2. **Software founder (Formcraft Tools as a product).** Takes releases, paying outside firms and a product team. Obstacle: release discipline and time split with Studio.
3. **Global BIM authority.** Takes published research, talks, standards work and open-source releases. Obstacle: visibility (65 followers, no public talks or papers yet).
4. **Registered architect.** Takes a degree the Architects Registration Board recognises, plus supervised practice and exams. Obstacle: an interior architecture degree likely does not qualify on its own.

The degree tension. A research master's in BIM serves the authority and software goals. Registration most likely needs a recognised architecture qualification (often a professional master's in architecture). Chosen route: ask the Architects Registration Board in 2027 what the interior architecture degree allows; take a professional master's in architecture after the BIM research master's if the Board requires it; treat registration as a 2030s goal, since it cannot happen in the next three years. Until then, registered professionals are engaged per project.

Lifetime ambition: USD 1 billion in revenue

The goal is reachable only if Formcraft keeps compounding for decades. In the feasibility study's base case Formcraft reaches about USD 1.03M of revenue in 2031, at age 29. From there, the growth rate decides when the total crosses USD 1 billion:



This profile's calculation from the feasibility study's 2031 base case (USD 1.03M)

In the year the goal is passed, yearly revenue would be about USD 170M (at 20%) to USD 314M (at 40%).

What it takes. A company with USD 150–300M of yearly revenue. A design studio and workshop alone do not reach that; four engines can:

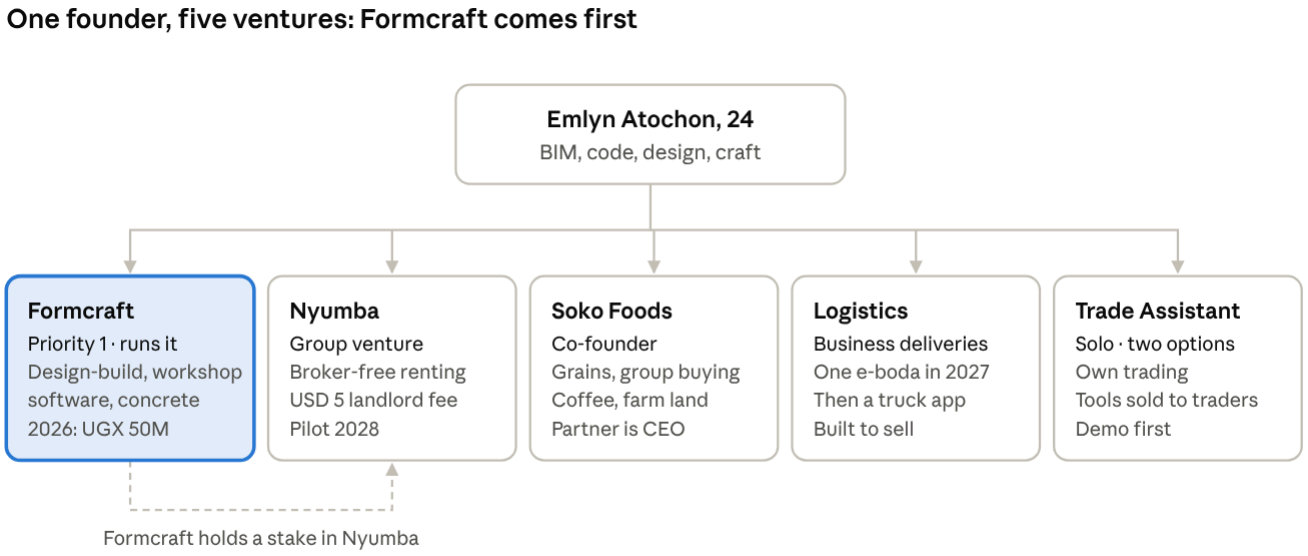
1. **Construction and real estate.** Building contracts and property sales carry large revenue per project; this is where most of the money would come from.
2. **Concrete and manufacturing.** Plants, precast and building products sold across the region.
3. **Software.** Formcraft Tools and the platform sold across Africa and beyond; smaller revenue, highest margin and value.
4. **Expansion.** Kenya, Rwanda, Tanzania, South Africa and other markets, each a full Formcraft.

Growing 25–40% a year for 20 years needs outside capital, a large team and leaders other than Emlyn, which pulls against the current 10% investor limit and the do-it-yourself habit. Both will need revisiting around 2031.

What counts. All four, tracked separately so nothing is counted twice:

- **Formcraft revenue:** yearly sales of Formcraft and its divisions. 2031 marker: about USD 1M.
- **Group revenue:** Formcraft plus any other company founded (software, fintech, manufacturing). 2031 marker: a second company started.
- **Value created:** valuation of companies he owns shares in, jobs created, artisans paid. 2031 marker: first outside valuation (the 10% stake).
- **Personal earnings:** salary, dividends, contract income, investment returns. Marker: a market salary from Formcraft by 2029.

Ventures



Ventures and roles, October 2026

Nyumba: a growing project

The problem it solves. 70% of Kampala households rent, about 370,000 households in the city alone (Census 2024). Tenants pay brokers inspection fees plus commissions the document puts at roughly 13–22% of a month's rent; listings are often fake; deposits are rarely returned; and nobody publishes what rent should cost.

The product. Free search and a parish-by-parish pricing map; verified listings; a one-dollar (UGX 3,700) contact unlock refunded if the listing is false; lawful written tenancies with protected deposits; rent payments matched to how people earn (daily, weekly, payday, USSD); a tenant-owned Rent Passport; a habitability badge; landlord and diaspora management tools; and scouts paid flat fees instead of brokers taking a share of rent.

The money (lean plan, from the document).

- **Revenue, years 1 / 2 / 3:** UGX 0.12 / 1.04 / 2.69 billion

- **Monthly revenue at month 36:** UGX 267M (about USD 72,000), from about 21,600 active tenancies
- **First profitable month:** month 29
- **Peak funding need:** UGX 1.6 billion (about USD 434,000); raise a pre-seed of USD 150k–200k, then a seed of USD 400k–500k, tied to milestones
- **Revenue mix by year 3:** collection fees 31%, diaspora management 29%, fundi marketplace 12%, unlocks 11%, placements 10%

How it fits Emlyn's profile.

- **Toward USD 1 billion.** Nyumba is a second engine for the group scorecard, and a software business with a much larger market than design fees: at month 36 its monthly revenue (about USD 72,000) would be more than half of Formcraft's whole 2028 revenue in the base case (USD 135k).
- **Shared skills.** The listing database, habitability checklist and condition records are structured building information, the same discipline as the Formcraft kit. The document itself says so.
- **Shared customers.** Landlords and developers on Nyumba are Formcraft Studio, Construction and template-build clients; Formcraft's real-estate division could later supply verified rental stock; Formcraft makers fit Nyumba's fundi marketplace.
- **The time clash.** 2027 is Formcraft's build year, and Emlyn has under 5 hours a week for anything else. Nyumba's own plan needs a full-time CEO, a technical lead, a field-operations lead and a product designer from month −6.
- **The money clash.** Nyumba needs USD 150k–200k before launch and about USD 434k at peak. That is outside money on a scale the 10% limit set for Formcraft does not allow, so Nyumba would be a separate company with its own investors.

Chosen path. Nyumba becomes a Formcraft group venture: a separate company in which Formcraft holds a stake and Emlyn holds shares personally. Emlyn is technical architect and owner, not day-to-day operator. A new co-founder leads it as CEO, with a former broker or agent as field-operations lead. Groundwork happens in 2027; launch is in 2028, after Formcraft's Year 1 exit gate. The first USD 150k–200k comes from grants, competitions and angel investors, who can take a larger share than Formcraft's 10% limit because Nyumba is a separate company.

1. **Q1 2027 · Emlyn:** choose a final name; check and register the trademark.
2. **Q1 2027 · Emlyn, about 2 hours a week:** design the data model (listings, habitability checklist, condition records, Rent Passport), reusing the Formcraft kit discipline.
3. **Q2 2027 · Emlyn with adviser:** brief a Ugandan advocate on tenancy, payments, data and scouts.

4. **Q2–Q3 2027 · Emlyn:** find a full-time co-founder CEO with proptech, fintech or field-sales experience.
5. **Q3 2027 · co-founder and an ex-broker:** two-week field study in candidate parishes: 200+ actual rents, LC1 chairs, ten landlords, twenty tenants.
6. **Q3–Q4 2027 · co-founder:** apply to proptech, fintech and youth-enterprise grants and competitions; open angel conversations.
7. **Q4 2027 · founders, with a lawyer:** agree the share split between Formcraft, Emlyn, the co-founder and the field lead, with vesting.
8. **Q1 2028 · co-founder CEO:** pre-seed closed, technical lead hired, scouts recruited, 300–500 units listed before any tenant marketing.
9. **2028 · Nyumba team:** pilot in 2–3 parishes; 300+ signed tenancies.

The rule that protects Formcraft. Emlyn's Nyumba time in 2027 stays within the weekly learning budget's spare hours. If Nyumba needs more, it waits for the co-founder; it never takes time from the Formcraft rebuild.

Custom Trade Assistant: an honest test bench for trading ideas

Repository [thyybot-dev/custom-trade-assistant](), reviewed 29 October 2026.

What it is. A research system that started as a Nasdaq momentum and order-block indicator ("Momentum OB") and is turning into a product: a local-first test bench where any trader brings their candles and their rule and gets an honest verdict in plain words. It reports trades after real costs, whether the result beats luck, whether it holds on data the rule never saw, and what a prop-firm challenge would likely do. The stated goal is to get people ready for a funded prop-firm account honestly, not to promise riches.

What is built (in 12 days).

- **Commits:** 410 since 17 October 2026
- **Code:** about 26,000 lines of Python and 2,400 of MQL5
- **Pieces:** MT5 indicator and monitor EAs; a Python reference detector with parity checks against MQL5; a strategy factory; exit, filter, news and time-of-day studies; Monte Carlo and prop-firm simulators (FTMO-style rules); a Replay Trainer page; a phone-first "Project Brain" dashboard
- **Evidence:** 227 tested results, 124 strategies in the library, 69 data sets
- **Discipline:** versioned specs, sealed "vault" data, random-entry baselines, reproducible run records, an AI-spend cap, and a rule that the core never depends on AI
- **Users:** none outside the founder yet

Honest results so far. The lead strategy on the Nasdaq (US100) shows 70 trades at about 0.2 R per trade, too few trades to prove an edge. The original order-block strategy loses money on EURNZD (219 trades, about −0.3 R per trade). The repository's own documents put prop-firm challenge pass rates at about 5–14%.

What it shows about Emlyn. This is his most disciplined software so far: specs before code, parity and correctness tests, sealed test data, scripted repeatable work, and a builder-reviewer loop between two AI agents. The same discipline would close the release gap in Formcraft's code.

How it fits.

- **Toward USD 1 billion:** a possible software business with a global market (retail traders, prop-firm candidates, EA developers, educators), sold in dollars.
- **The time question:** 410 commits in 12 days alongside Formcraft looks like far more than 5 hours a week, but Emlyn puts in under 5 hours a week; AI agents do most of the work unattended, on a capped AI budget. The risk is attention, not hours: reviewing what the agents build still pulls focus from the Formcraft rebuild.
- **The money rule still applies:** demo accounts only for testing; any live or prop-firm money comes from the separate trading budget (at most 10% of savings), never Formcraft cash.
- **Validate before building more:** the repository's own plan says to show the verdict card to five to ten serious traders and see whether they would pay. That is the next step, not more features.
- **Public repository:** strategy research, results and the product plan are public. If any edge or product idea should be protected, consider making it private.

Chosen path. The Trade Assistant stays a personal tool and Emlyn's route to a funded prop-firm account, not a product or a group company for now. In 2027 the order is Formcraft first, then Nyumba groundwork, then trading.

1. **Feature freeze.** No new modules in 2027; the agents only maintain, re-run studies and keep the monitor EAs running.
2. **AI budget.** Keep the monthly and per-run caps set in the repository (placeholders are USD 20 a month and USD 3 a run).
3. **Forward test first.** Run the lead strategy on demo at real size for at least 3 months and 100+ trades before any paid challenge.
4. **Challenge rule.** Buy a prop challenge only when the simulator's pass estimate and the demo record agree; the fee comes from the trading budget.
5. **Fee cap.** At most two challenge fees a year, treated as planned experiments, never chased after a loss.

6. **Review.** Each quarter: trades, R per trade with its error, challenge results, money spent; stop if the edge disappears.
7. **Product later.** Revisit selling it only after a funded account has paid out, which proves the method on real money.

Soko Foods: food security from farm to family

What it is. A dry-foods business for Uganda: buying grains and flours from farmers, and collective buying so communities get staple food at fair, steady prices. A second arm owns and runs farms, starting with coffee, as private agricultural real estate.

Full strategy (October 2026). Around the trading core: private and public silos with warehouse receipts; supply contracts with schools, the army and other institutions; franchised bulk-food shops where families buy any amount rather than 1 kg packs, plus online ordering; and coffee, cocoa and vanilla plantations funded plot by plot by private investors. Every arm is meant to run with AI assistants, the way Emlyn built Formcraft's tools. In the scenarios tab this full plan lifts the lifetime billion odds from 9.9% to 12.8%, and to 22% if AI help really cuts failure risk; overstretch would cut them to 7.5%.

Emlyn's role. Co-founder; a partner is CEO. Funding stays private: the founders and people close to them, no outside investors.

Why it can be the biggest of the four. Food trading turns over large sums even at thin margins, and every household buys staples every week. That is why it reaches USD 1 billion of revenue first in the plan below. The trade-off: margins of a few percent, so revenue is not profit, and stock, storage and price swings carry real risk.

How it fits.

- Formcraft can design and build its stores, mills and farm buildings at cost plus a fee.
- Emlyn's software habits (data models, dashboards) suit buying records, stock and member accounts.
- It needs little of his weekly time if the CEO runs operations; his job is board seat, systems and capital discipline.

First steps (assumed, to confirm with the CEO).

1. **2027:** register the company and agree shares and vesting between the founders, with a lawyer.
2. **2027:** pilot collective buying with 2–3 communities and a handful of farmer groups; track price saved per household.
3. **2028:** a store and simple processing (cleaning, milling, packing) once the pilot pays for itself.

4. **From 2028:** buy or lease the first coffee land; coffee takes about three years to a first harvest, so plant early.

Open questions. Who the CEO is and their background; the share split; the first district; how much private money is ready for land.

Logistics: SafeBoda for businesses, then Uber for trucks

A business delivery company in Kampala that starts with one electric boda (about USD 1,000), adds riders one by one, then becomes an app where businesses book trucks for building sites, moving and grain. Construction firms need trucks every day, and with about 70% of Kampala households renting and moving often, so do movers. Formcraft's materials, Soko's grain and Nyumba's tenants give it its first trips.

The courier is cheap and likely to survive but stays small; the truck app is where the scale is, and it is the hardest step: Kobo360, Africa's best-known truck marketplace, raised about USD 79M and stalled. The scenarios tab has the staged plan, the gates and the odds.

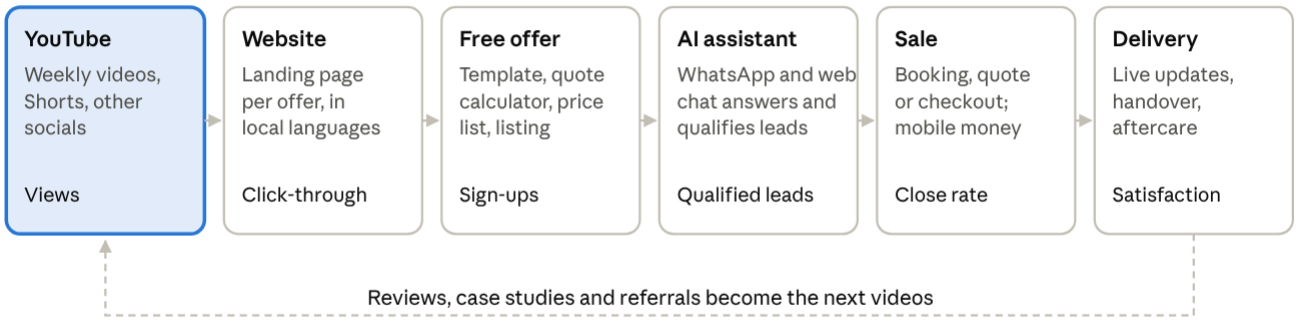
Open questions. Who rides the first bike, the first five business clients, the brand name, and Emlyn's stake if partners join.

Media and sales engine

Every venture gets a YouTube channel, a website built for one next step, and an AI assistant that answers and qualifies buyers day and night. The channels' own income stays modest, about USD 0.2M a year across all five by 2036, but the customers they bring are worth far more: in the simulation, visibility adds about 10 points to the lifetime billion odds against about 1 point from ad money.

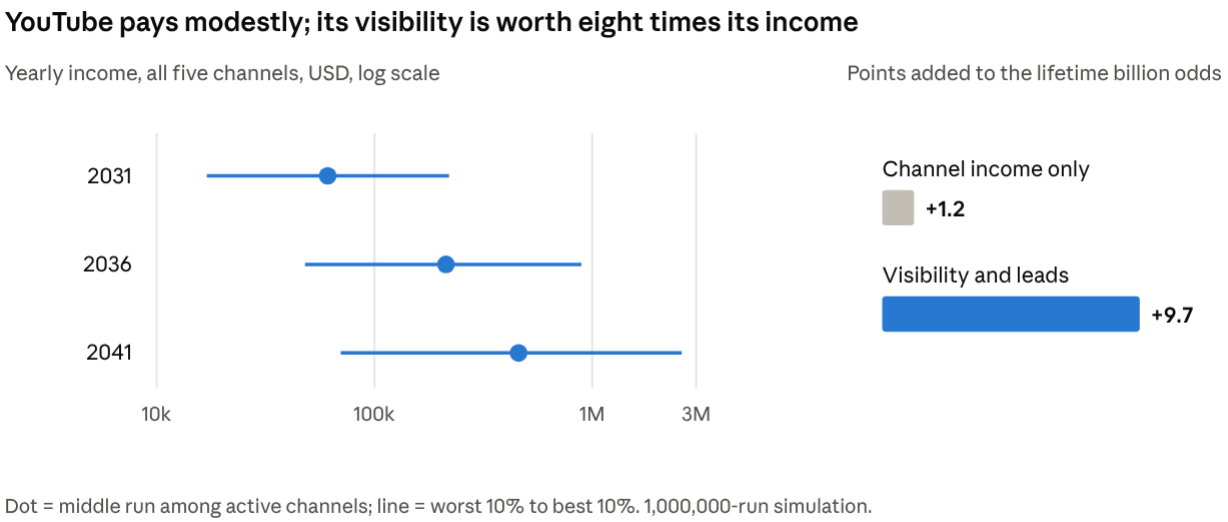
One sales engine for every venture: video in, customer out, story back in

Each company runs this loop; AI handles editing, the website, the chat assistant and follow-up



Bottom line of each box = the number to track monthly at that step.

The same loop runs for every venture; each has its own channel, site and assistant



Simulation results; visibility = lower failure risk and faster growth from inbound leads, an assumption to test

The five channels.

- **Formcraft:** BIM, Revit and AI-in-Revit lessons for a global audience; projects and furniture from sketch to handover. Education is YouTube's best-paid niche, at a median of about USD 10 per 1,000 views. Emlyn's face and voice are the channel.
- **Soko Foods:** farm-to-table stories, grain quality, food prices, plantation diaries for investors.
- **Logistics:** a day on the road, construction-logistics tips, the economics of electric bodas.
- **Nyumba:** neighbourhood tours, renting guides, landlord tips, a series for landlords abroad.
- **Trade Assistant:** honest strategy tests and forward-test diaries, no profit promises.

How it runs. One long video and three Shorts a week per channel, filmed from real work. AI edits, captions, translates into Luganda, Swahili and French, writes titles and thumbnails, and turns each video into posts for other platforms. Each video ends with one link to one offer.

What the record says. Most channels earn little: the top 10% take 58% of ad revenue, and only about 4.3% of creators make over USD 100,000 a year. What pays reliably is the lead: content marketing brings customers at about 62% lower cost than outbound selling. So the channels are judged on leads and sales, not views.

Numbers to hit by end-2028, per channel: 52 long videos published, 1,000 subscribers (YouTube's partner threshold), 100 website sign-ups a month, and at least 10% of new customers saying they found the company on YouTube.

The billion plan

On the full plan (five ventures, AI in each, YouTube channels and sales funnels, and expansion from Kampala to the world), combined revenue passes USD 1 billion before age 70 in **40%** of 1,000,000 simulated lives, by 2047 (age 45) in 7.8%, and by age 55 in 27%. If everything went exactly to plan, it would arrive in 2043, at 41. Without AI or YouTube, the same ventures give 10.5%. The workings are in Honest scenarios and risks ; each venture alone is in Each venture on its own .

The numbers to hit. About USD 11.2M of combined revenue in 2031, then about 18% growth a year. Soko Foods carries 72% of that 2031 figure.

If only some work. Soko alone gets there by 2046; Formcraft and Soko together by 2045; any three including Soko by 2044–2045.

The plan, in five stages.

1. **2027–2028: Kampala.** Formcraft first; Logistics' first e-boda; Soko's pilot; Nyumba's CEO search; the Trade Assistant's tools on sale. All five channels and websites live by end-2027.
2. **2029–2031: Uganda.** A leader for each venture; Soko's arms open; Nyumba profitable; the truck app tested. Target: USD 11.2M combined in 2031.
3. **2032–2036: East Africa.** Nairobi, Kigali and Dar es Salaam offices or partners; a holding company owns the stakes. Formcraft Tools sold across the region.
4. **2037–2041: Africa.** Franchise and licence models in West and Southern Africa; plantation exports.
5. **2042 on: the world.** Software, content and commodity exports compete globally; reinvest, acquire, and start a new venture every five years.

Rules that keep four ventures from sinking each other.

- One full-time CEO per venture; Emlyn runs only Formcraft day to day.
- No venture funds another's losses without a written board decision.
- Each venture has a yearly gate. Miss it two years running and it is merged, sold or shut.
- Emlyn's personal money stays out of all four beyond agreed stakes.

Health and energy

Today: short sleep, frequent late-night builds, little exercise, and feeling stretched. All four warning signs are present. This is the most urgent item in the profile: a burned-out founder is the fastest way for every plan here to fail, and the Year 1 build is about to add load. If the stretched feeling includes poor sleep that won't recover, low mood or exhaustion that lasts for weeks, see a doctor.

Start small in November 2026, before the rebuild begins:

- [ ] Seven hours of sleep as the default; no all-night builds more than once a month
- [ ] Exercise three times a week
- [ ] One full day off each week; at least one week off each year
- [ ] Yearly medical check-up

Personal finances

Today: no savings yet, and personal and Formcraft money are not fully separate. Fix the separation first: it protects you, makes the company's books trustworthy for VAT, bids and the future 10% investor, and shows what you actually earn.

1. Open a personal account separate from Formcraft's this month.
2. Formcraft pays you a fixed monthly stipend by transfer; no more personal spending from company cash.
3. Save a fixed amount from every payment, even UGX 50,000, until one month of costs is saved, then three.
4. Record any money you have lent the company as a director's loan, so it can be repaid later.

- **Emergency fund:** three months of personal costs, in a savings account
- **Income:** stipend now; market salary from 2029; contract income (BIM, MQL5) on top
- **Saving rate:** 20% of personal income
- **Trading capital:** at most 10% of savings, in a separate account
- **Long-term investments:** begin once the emergency fund is full
- **Insurance:** health cover; key-person cover through Formcraft from 2028

Family and relationships

Mostly independent, and supporting siblings. That support is a fixed cost the personal budget must cover first, before savings or trading.

- Budget sibling support as a monthly line, paid from the stipend.
- Keep a small education reserve for their school fees, so a slow month at Formcraft does not interrupt their schooling.
- Protect one family day or evening each week; it also forces the day off the health plan needs.

Giving back

Having made his own way since Senior Two, Emlyn wants to help others in similar positions. Formcraft already has the channels:

- **Orphans and vulnerable students:** Academy places and internships reserved each year.
- **Artisans:** the 20%-of-profits pledge as training and machine access.
- **Graduates:** template-builds royalties and supervised experience toward registration.
- Housing: one affordable template-build design each year, offered at cost to low-income families. **Later:** a foundation, once personal and company finances allow.

Education and credentials

- **Held:** Bachelor's degree, Interior Architecture, Limkokwing University (Uganda)
- **Held:** Certificate (subject to confirm)
- **Q1 2027:** Autodesk Certified Professional, Revit for Architectural Design
- **Mid-2027:** Autodesk Certified Professional, Revit for Mechanical Design and Revit for Electrical Design
- **Late 2027:** Autodesk Certified Professional, Revit for Structural Design
- **2027:** BIM certificate (ISO 19650 or buildingSMART Foundation)
- **From about 2029:** Master's degree in BIM

Each Autodesk exam costs USD 200, lasts 120 minutes and is valid for 3 years. The structural exam expects about 400–1,200 hours of structural Revit work.

Registration. Being a registered architect of record in Uganda most likely needs an architecture degree recognised by the Architects Registration Board; to confirm with the Board. Until then, registered architects and engineers are engaged per project.

Skills and software stack

- **Building modelling and coordination:** Revit 2025/2026, Navisworks clash checks, Robot structural analysis, ArchiCAD (early), Rhino
- **Design and visualisation:** Dynamo, Blender (Cycles), architectural renders, interiors, furniture and joinery design
- **Development:** C# (Revit API add-in), TypeScript/Node (tools server), Python (pyRevit, build scripts), React and Firebase (website)
- **AI:** Claude as an agent inside Revit through MCP, with written rules, dry runs and named human approval

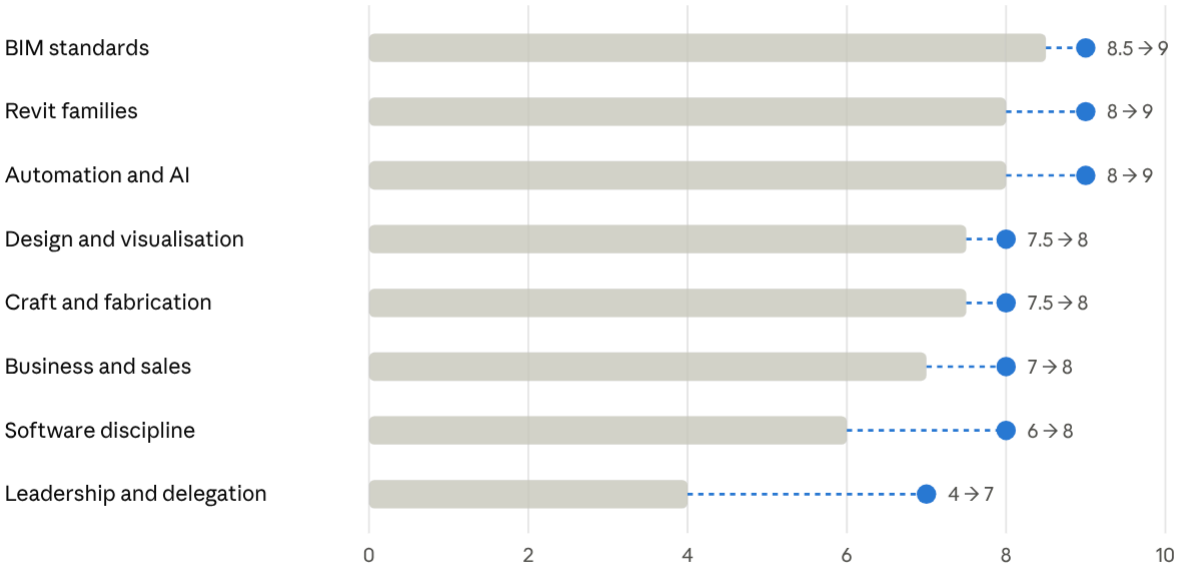
- **Standards:** ISO 19650 workflow, IFC 4/4.3, IDS, BCF, COBie, Uniclass; a 101-page BIM manual, 204 shared parameters, 412 keynote codes
- **Making:** workshop production of wardrobes, kitchens, sofas, beds and cabinetry
- **Delivery:** Git and GitHub, CI builds, test-finding loops

Rating against international roles

Overall about 7.5 out of 10 today, rising to 8 or more once the certificates and master's are done. The gaps are delegation and release discipline, which no certificate fixes.

Biggest climbs by 2028: leadership (4 to 7) and software discipline (6 to 8)

Skill scores out of 10: bar = today, dot = 2028 target



This profile's assessment, October 2026; 2028 targets set with Emlyn

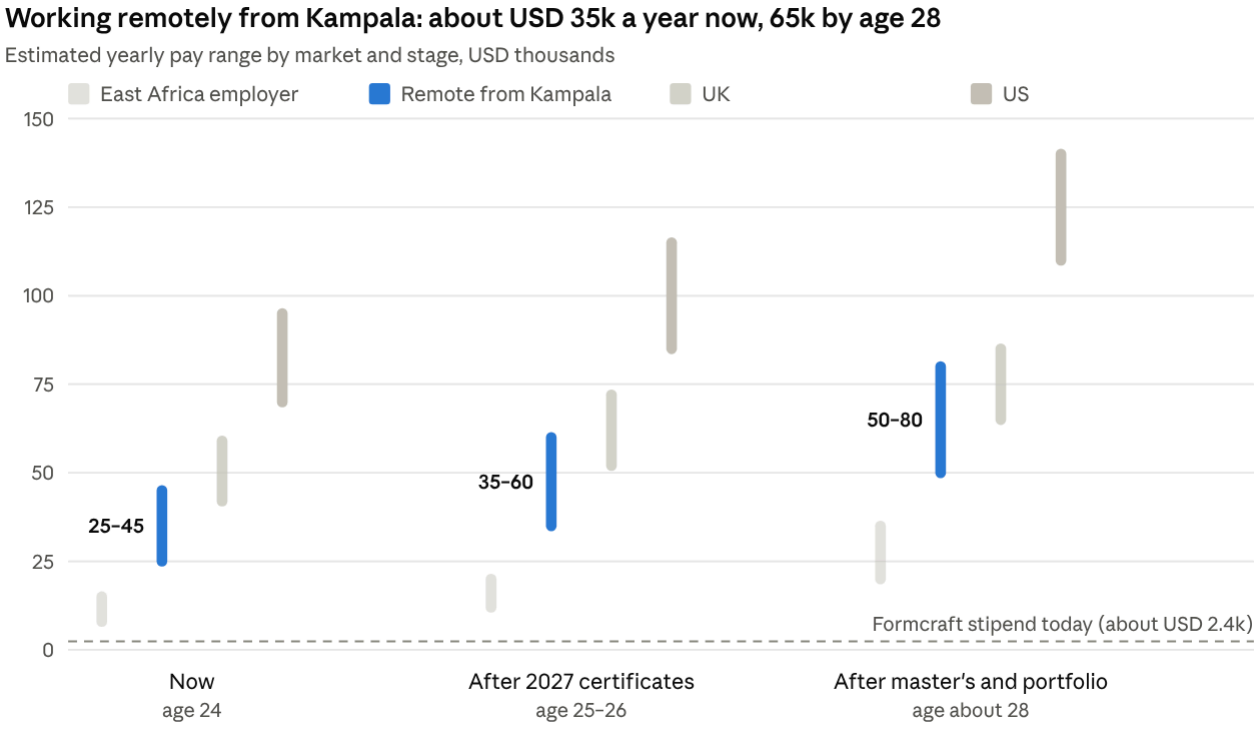
Evidence behind the scores

- **BIM standards (8.5):** firm-grade kit, ISO 19650-aligned, open delivery, coded and priced elements.
- **Revit families (8):** 371+ families built by the engine; LOD 400 work on Ogala.
- **Automation and AI (8):** Claude editing Revit under written rules and human gates.
- **Design and visualisation (7.5):** strong renders and interiors; built architecture still thin.
- **Craft and fabrication (7.5):** real workshop output and furniture finishing.
- **Business and sales (7):** clear vision; fees too low.
- **Software discipline (6):** strong in the trading repository; no Formcraft releases yet.
- **Leadership and delegation (4):** everything still runs through him.

Roles he could apply for now: BIM Automation Developer, Computational BIM Specialist, Senior BIM Coordinator, BIM Manager at a small or mid-size firm. **Not yet:** BIM Director or BIM Manager at a large multinational.

Market value

His outside market value is USD 25k–95k a year today depending on where he works, against a Formcraft stipend of about USD 2,400 a year. That gap is the real cost of building Formcraft.

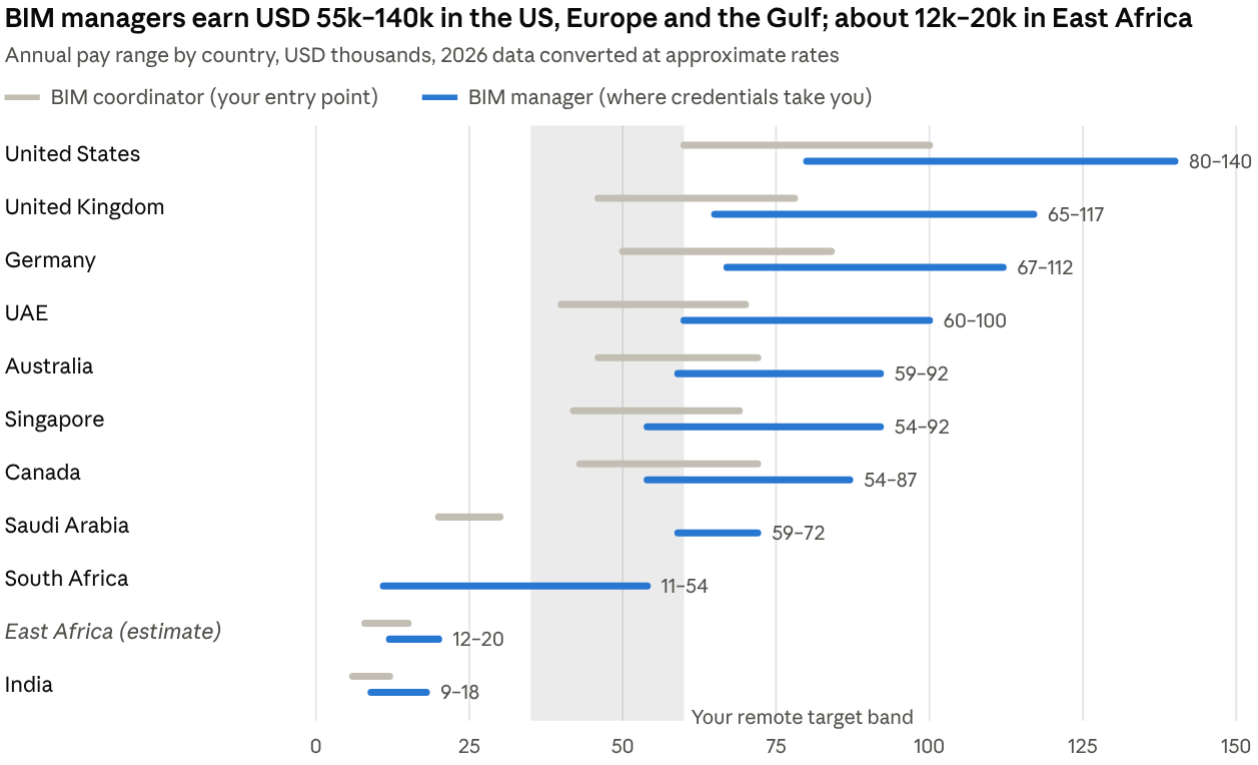


This profile's estimates by stage; UK converted at about USD 1.30 per pound

These are estimates, anchored to published 2026 pay: UK BIM manager median £36k early-career and £51k experienced; a US BIM developer role at $118k–138k; a senior BIM computational designer at $85k–110k. East African figures are approximate; no reliable published data was found. Freelance automation or BIM work: about USD 25–50 an hour.

Market comparison by country

The same skills pay about ten times more in North America, Western Europe or the Gulf than in East Africa. Your realistic entry point today is the BIM coordinator or specialist band; the BIM manager band is where the certificates and master's take you.



Novatr 2026 salary table (US, UK, Germany, UAE, Australia, Singapore, Canada, India); PayScale 2026 (Saudi manager, South Africa manager); GulfTalent BIM engineer average (Saudi coordinator band); East Africa is this profile's estimate. Converted at approx. GBP 1.30, EUR 1.12, AED 3.67, SAR 3.75, CAD 1.38, AUD 1.52, SGD 1.30, ZAR 18, INR 85 per USD.

The shaded band is the USD 35k–60k a year a remote contract from Kampala can realistically pay in 2027–2028: already three times the East African manager band, without moving. Sources: Novatr, PayScale Saudi Arabia, PayScale South Africa, GulfTalent.

Freelance rates. On Upwork, intermediate freelancers typically charge USD 25–60 an hour and specialised development or AI work USD 60–120+. API developers with 0–2 years run USD 25–50 an hour, mid-level USD 50–95. With a Revit API plus AI niche and a public portfolio, USD 35–60 an hour is a realistic start; that is USD 50k–85k a year at 1,400 billable hours.

Watch the Gulf split. Saudi BIM manager medians sit around SAR 238k (about USD 63k), yet some recruitment agencies advertise Riyadh BIM manager roles at SAR 8,000–10,000 a month with housing. Pay there depends heavily on passport and employer; aim for direct hires by international consultancies.

How you would fare by region

- **East Africa (Uganda, Kenya, Rwanda): lead your own firm.** Demand is growing but small, and you are already here. Edge: local codes, materials, the workshop, few rivals. Handicap: low budgets; clients pay for drawings, not BIM. Best long-term upside.
- **Remote for UK and Europe: yes, from 2027.** Strong demand for automation and content, by freelance or contract; UTC+3 overlaps their working day. Edge: cost and the Revit API + AI niche. Handicap: no certificates or public portfolio yet.
- **Gulf (UAE, Saudi): after certificates and 1–2 big-project references.** Very strong demand from giga-projects; needs a job offer and work visa, 3–6 hours' flight. Edge: same time zone, BIM standards depth. Handicap: pay varies by passport; large-project coordination experience expected.
- **UK: via the master's (graduate route).** Strong demand; the home of ISO 19650, so your standards fluency fits. Handicap: skilled-worker visas need a sponsor and years of experience.
- **Western Europe (Germany, Netherlands): after the master's.** BIM mandates are spreading and automation skills are scarce. Routes: skilled-worker or EU Blue Card. Handicap: language and degree recognition.
- **North America: remote contracts first.** Highest pay (Revit API developers earn USD 118k+), but the hardest visas and steep experience requirements.
- **South Africa: partnerships, not employment.** Moderate demand, work permit needed. Edge: African market knowledge. Handicap: modest pay (median about USD 30k).
- **India: not a target.** A large, low-pay market and a drafting competitor on price you cannot beat.

Visa rules change often; check each route before acting.

What you bring

- **A rare combination.** Few people combine a working workshop, a firm-grade BIM standard, Revit API development and AI agents in one person. Most firms hire three people for that.
- **AI-in-Revit at the frontier.** Claude editing Revit under written rules, dry runs and human gates is ahead of most practices worldwide.
- **Standards authorship.** You wrote a standard; most BIM coordinators only follow one.
- **Time zone and cost.** UTC+3 shares working hours with the UK, Europe and the Gulf, at a fraction of their cost.
- **African market knowledge.** Local materials, codes and construction reality that foreign firms entering Africa lack.

- **Age and speed.** 24 years old with a body of work many reach at 30.

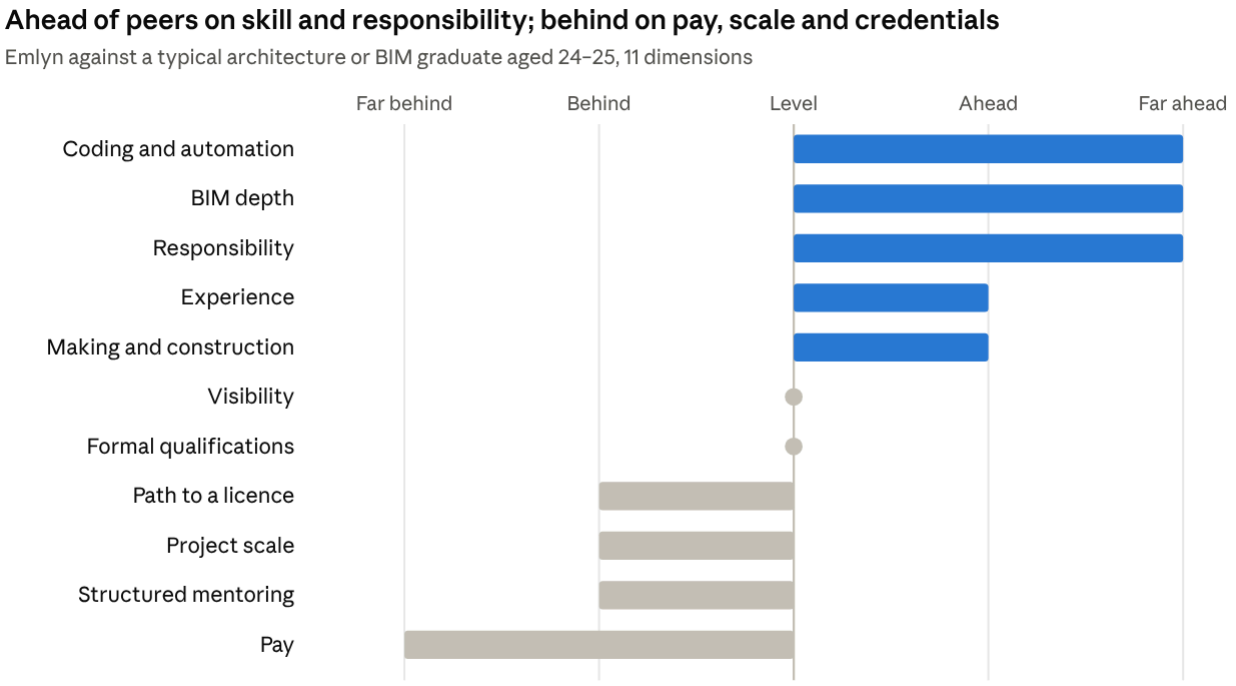
Compared with professionals your age (24–25)

On technical capability and ownership you are well ahead of your global peers; on credentials, project scale, mentored training and pay you are behind. Most 24-year-olds in architecture and BIM are still in structured training inside larger firms.

Where your peers are at 24–25

- **UK.** Finishing a master's in architecture (RIBA Part 2) or working as an architectural assistant; registration needs Part 3 later. Pay: Part 1 assistant £22k–28k, Part 2 assistant £28k–36k, junior BIM technician £25k–35k.
- **US.** Graduate designer, years from a licence: new architects average about 32.5 years old, about 13.3 years after starting college. Pay: entry-level BIM roles around USD 90k in major markets.
- **Gulf.** Junior BIM modeller, often recruited through agencies. Pay: some modeller roles at SAR 4,000–8,000 a month with housing.
- **East Africa.** Graduate assistant or intern, many without supervised work. Pay: low; no reliable published data.

Side by side



This profile's judgement, October 2026

- **Far ahead.** Coding: peers have little beyond some Dynamo; you built a Revit API add-in, a tools server and AI agents in Revit, rare at any age. BIM: peers work inside someone else's standard; you wrote one (manual, 204 parameters, 412 keynotes). Responsibility: peers draw under supervision; you run a company, clients, a workshop and design.
- **Ahead.** About 2–4 years of experience against their 1–2, and workshop production where they rarely touch fabrication.
- **Level.** Visibility (both small). Qualifications: a bachelor's is enough for BIM roles, but behind peers finishing a professional master's for registration.
- **Behind.** No accredited licence route yet; homes and interiors rather than large multi-discipline projects; no structured mentoring.
- **Far behind.** Pay: about USD 2,400 a year stipend against UK £22k–36k and far higher in the US.

What it means. Your peers trade ownership for structure: steady pay, mentors, big projects and a licence path. You traded structure for ownership. The skills you've built are ones most of them won't have by 30. The plan's job is to buy back the missing structure without giving up ownership: mentors, certificates, large-project exposure through sub-consulting and public bids, and documented references.

Skill gaps

Ranked by how much each one holds back pay and the four goals.

Skill gaps 1–10, placed by this profile's judgement, October 2026

1. **Track record.** Employers and tenders count years and references. *Fix:* case studies with client references for every job; a LinkedIn record. *From 2027.*
2. **Credentials.** Recruiters filter on certificates. *Fix:* four Revit certificates and ISO 19650, then the research master's. *2027; 2029–2030.*
3. **Large projects.** International roles expect multi-discipline coordination at scale. *Fix:* BIM sub-consulting on a large project; public bids. *2028–2029.*
4. **Construction Cloud and cloud APIs.** Most international firms run Autodesk Construction Cloud. *Fix:* use it on one live job; build one small web tool on Autodesk's APIs. *2027–2028.*
5. **Software discipline.** *Fix:* monthly releases; architecture written before code, as in the trading repository. *2027.*
6. **Engineering depth.** Needed to design, not only model. *Fix:* work alongside the engaged engineers on every job. *2027–2028.*

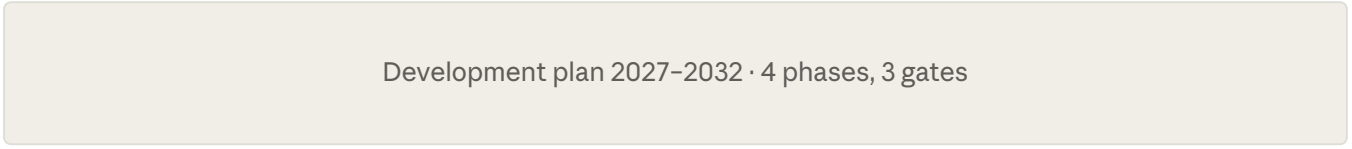
7. **Leadership.** The lowest score. *Fix:* hand two jobs to staff; one management course. *2027–2028.*
8. **Built portfolio.** Renders are not proof of delivery. *Fix:* photograph Ogala and every job as it rises. *From 2027.*
9. **Visibility.** *Fix:* video, writing, talks and one open-source release. *From 2027.*
10. **Business and finance.** *Fix:* fixed packages and prices, a monthly cash report, a business mentor. *2027.*

Top 10 actions to raise your profile

1. Build a one-page portfolio site and LinkedIn profile with three case studies and a 2-minute video of the AI building families.
2. Pass Revit for Architectural Design in Q1 2027.
3. Ship the rebuilt server as a public, tagged release with a clean README; keep the core private.
4. Win three remote contracts (drafting, families or Revit automation) at USD 35–60 an hour.
5. Get client references in writing for Ogala and every 2027 job.
6. Take the ISO 19650 course and use its language in every proposal.
7. Use Autodesk Construction Cloud on one live project.
8. Find one BIM mentor abroad and one business mentor in Kampala.
9. Give two local talks in 2027 and submit one international talk for 2028.
10. Hand two residential jobs to staff in 2027 and review only at gates.

Development plan 2027–2031

Four phases from age 24 to 30, each ending at a gate.



Each gate must be met before the next phase starts; the first phase carries the most risk because the build, the certificates and the health reset all land in the same year.

The master's risk. A full-time year abroad in 2029 lands when Formcraft can least absorb his absence. Chosen route: a research master's, with the thesis built on the Formcraft system, so study and company work feed each other.

Focus for 2027–2028. Software engineering, engineering depth (structure and MEP beyond Revit) and business and sales. Leadership was not chosen; it remains the lowest score (4/10) and the biggest risk to the company, so the plan keeps a minimum: hire and hand over to a junior developer and a QA modeller in 2027.

Development tracks

Four tracks, each with concrete actions. Every action either ships something for Formcraft or earns a credential, so learning never competes with the company for time.

1. Software engineering

- **Nov 2026–Feb 2027:** rebuild the MCP server cleanly, architecture written down first, tests from F-001 to F-074. Proof: a tagged v0.1 release.
- **2027:** monthly releases, at most 5 open pull requests, code review with the junior developer. Proof: 12 releases in a row.
- **2027:** one structured topic per quarter (software architecture, testing, security, cloud deployment). Proof: notes in the dev rulebook.

2. Engineering depth

- **Structural design.** 2027: model and check the Ogala RC frame with the engaged structural engineer; Robot basics. 2028: meet the Revit Structural experience hours; design small frames under review.
- **MEP systems.** 2027: learn the design logic behind the 23 MEP calculation systems in the tools. 2028: apply the Revit Mechanical and Electrical certificates on live jobs.
- **Construction methods.** 2027: visit every Formcraft site weekly; record sequencing and costs against the model. 2028: lead the first supervised build with the partner contractor.
- **Building codes.** 2027: study the National Building Code and the Building Control Act; build them into the Uganda kit layer. 2028: a permit checklist used on every Studio job.

3. Business and sales

- **Pricing and proposals:** publish fixed design packages and one proposal template per division. Measure: average residential fee from UGX 10M to 14M by 2028.
- **Finance and cash:** a monthly one-page cash report; learn to read profit and loss and the balance sheet. Measure: three months of costs always in reserve.
- **Selling to firms:** list 50 target firms (Uganda, Kenya, Gulf, UK); 10 contacts a week for drafting and families. Measure: first 3 outside clients by mid-2027.
- **Public tenders:** register on e-GP; join 4–6 bids as sub-consultant in 2028. Measure: first lead bid won by 2029.

4. Visibility (the global BIM authority goal)

- **Video:** short clips (AI building a family overnight, model to cut list, render to finished piece). 2027 target: 2 clips a month on LinkedIn, YouTube and Instagram.
- **Writing:** case studies from Ogala and the healthcare pack; later, papers from the research master's. Target: 6 articles; 1 conference paper by 2029.
- **Speaking:** local BIM and architecture events first, then African and international ones. Target: 2 local talks in 2027; 1 international by 2029.
- **Open source:** release small non-core pieces (helpers, examples); keep the kit, recipes and rules private. Target: one public repository with releases.

5. Media and sales engine (new)

- **2027:** learn on-camera presenting, scripting and simple editing; launch the Formcraft channel first, then one channel a quarter. Target: 52 long videos on the Formcraft channel.
- **2027:** build the AI production stack (editing, captions, translation, thumbnails) and the website funnel template reused by all five companies.
- **2028:** hire or train one content producer per two channels; every channel at 1,000 subscribers and tracking leads, not views.
- **2029 on:** paid courses and sponsorships on the Formcraft and Trade Assistant channels; a personal channel for Emlyn on building companies with AI.

Registration (long track). 2027: ask the Board. 2029–2030: research master's. 2031 onward: professional architecture master's if required, then supervised practice and exams; registration in the mid-2030s.

Time, funding and support

Time: under 5 hours a week. That is about 200–250 hours a year. It is enough for the certificates only because most of the learning happens inside paid work: the rebuild teaches software engineering, Ogala and site visits teach structure and construction, the MEP tools teach MEP. Study time goes only to exam preparation and short courses.

Approximate hours, planned with Emlyn

The master's needs more time. A research master's typically asks for 15–20 hours a week part-time, or full-time study. From 2029 that time has to come out of Formcraft work, which only works once the handover milestones in the feasibility study are met.

Funding: scholarship, Formcraft and own savings, in the UK, Europe, Africa or online. These pull in two directions. Most fully funded scholarships pay for full-time, in-person study, while online and part-time research master's are usually paid by the student or employer. So keep two paths:

- **A: scholarship, full-time, UK or Europe.** The scholarship covers fees and living costs. Apply 2028, study 2029–2030, only after handover.
- **B: part-time research, online or at an African university.** Formcraft pays fees as staff development; savings cover the rest. Start 2029, 2–3 years.

If path A is won, take it; otherwise path B runs by default. Confirm each scholarship's current rules directly; they change yearly.

Support: all four.

- **BIM mentor abroad:** standards, career, international roles. Find through buildingSMART chapters, LinkedIn, conference speakers.
- **Business mentor in East Africa:** pricing, cash, hiring, investors. Find through founder networks, incubators, banks' SME programmes.
- **Registered architect mentor:** the registration path and stamping practice. Find among the architects engaged per project, or the Uganda Society of Architects.
- **Peer network:** problem-solving, visibility, referrals. Find in online BIM and Revit API communities and local AEC meetups.

Aim: one monthly call with each mentor from 2027, which costs about 4 hours a month and sits inside the weekly budget.

Open questions

Being answered with Emlyn; each answer updates the sections above.

- [x] ~~Years of real project experience: about 2–4, including employment and freelance~~
- [x] ~~Career goals by 30: all four (lead Formcraft, software founder, BIM authority, registered architect)~~
- [x] ~~Master's format: research master's, thesis on the Formcraft system~~
- [x] ~~Focus areas and tracks: software, engineering depth, business and sales, visibility~~
- [ ] What the existing certificate is
- [x] ~~Master's funding: scholarship (path A) or Formcraft plus savings (path B); UK, Europe, Africa or online~~
- [x] ~~Learning time: under 5 hours a week, about 215 hours in 2027~~
- [x] ~~Support: BIM, business and architect mentors plus a peer network~~